Makerere University
BSE4104 Emerging Trends in Software Engineering
Group M Evening

MCP-style Interface Specification

create_support_case

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This note specifies one capability that is already in the freshman-support application. It records the capability, its inputs, its outputs, who may call it, and its security boundary.

1. Capability

create_support_case saves one local support draft for a freshman onboarding issue and attaches a queue label so staff can follow up later. The application assigns the case id. The tool may record a question the student has agreed to file. It stays inside that draft: admissions, grading, discipline, and fee decisions remain with staff, and resolving, closing, or reassigning the case remains with staff.

2. Inputs

The caller sends three fields. The application attaches the chat's session id, and it assigns the case id when the draft is saved.

Field	Required	Rule
student_identifier	Yes	Registration number. Two digits, then U or X, then four or five digits, with an optional /PS or /EVE. Letters are stored in uppercase. Examples: 23/U/9393, 23/U/22615, 23/X/93939/EVE.
issue_summary	Yes	A short description of the unresolved onboarding issue. Empty text is rejected.
category	Yes	One of it_webmail_wifi, registration, fees_informational, accommodation, other_unclassified.

3. Outputs

A call returns one of three results.

Saved draft. The status is created.

Field	Meaning
case_id	Assigned by the application, in the form CASE-2026-000001.
session_id	The chat session the draft belongs to.
routed_queue	The staff queue for the category that was sent.
created_at	The time the draft was saved, in UTC.

The queue for each category is fixed.

Category sent	routed_queue returned
it_webmail_wifi	ict_helpdesk
registration	registration_office
fees_informational	fees_information
accommodation	accommodation_office
other_unclassified	general_onboarding

Invalid fields. The status is validation_error. The result includes validation_errors, a list of field and message for each rejected input. Nothing is saved.

Refused call. The status is error. The result includes a message and no case id. This is returned when the chat has no session, the summary is an admissions, grading, or discipline matter, a fee waiver, refund, or approval appears in the student's message or only in issue_summary, the student has not agreed, or this chat already has a draft. It is also returned when the turn has already used 3 tool calls, and when create_support_case has already been corrected once in that turn.

4. Who may call it

The application is the only caller that executes create_support_case. The model may request it. The student and staff never call it themselves.

The tool is placed on the model's allow-list for a turn only when both of these are true:

The student has pressed “I agree to save a support draft” in the sidebar. A sentence in the chat does not count as agreement.
This chat does not already have a saved draft.

The application still refuses the request when the question is about admissions, grading, or discipline, when the student says they are a continuing, returning, or postgraduate student, when the message tries to override the assistant's rules, or when a fee waiver, refund, or approval appears in the message or only in issue_summary. A fee question can be filed only as a question.

One chat keeps one draft. In a single turn the tool may be tried twice: the first attempt, and one correction after a validation error.

5. Security boundary

create_support_case stays inside the application and writes one record to the local drafts file, data/cases/drafts.json. That folder is excluded from git, so the draft is not committed.

The saved record holds the case id, the session id, the registration number, the issue summary, the category, the queue label, and the time it was saved. The application sets the case id and the session id. A session id sent by the caller is removed before the save.

The queue name on that record is a label for later staff follow-up. The tool leaves the document corpus, the model provider, and the university offices outside its write path. Resolving, closing, and reassigning a case stay outside this tool, as do admissions, grading, discipline, and fee decisions.